

10 — Schemas & Namespacing in PostgreSQL

Table of Contents

1. [Learning Objectives](#)
2. [What is a Schema?](#)
3. [The search_path](#)
4. [Creating and Managing Schemas](#)
5. [Schema-Level Permissions](#)
6. [Default Schemas in PostgreSQL](#)
7. [Cross-Schema Queries](#)
8. [Schema Design Patterns](#)
9. [Multi-Tenant Schema Patterns](#)
10. [Extensions and Schemas](#)
11. [SQL Examples](#)
12. [Common Mistakes](#)
13. [Best Practices](#)
14. [Performance Considerations](#)
15. [Interview Questions & Answers](#)
16. [Exercises with Solutions](#)
17. [Cross-References](#)

Learning Objectives

After completing this section you will be able to:

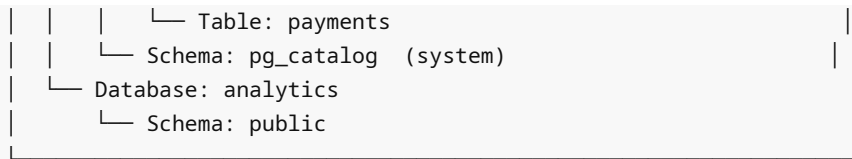
- Create and organize objects using schemas
- Configure `search_path` for correct object resolution
- Design permission models using schema-level grants
- Implement multi-tenant applications using schema-per-tenant
- Avoid common `search_path` injection vulnerabilities

What is a Schema?

A **schema** is a namespace within a database that groups related objects (tables, views, functions, sequences, types, etc.).

PostgreSQL Object Hierarchy:

```
| Cluster (PostgreSQL server) |
| └─ Database: myapp         |
|   | └─ Schema: public      (default) | |
|   |   | └─ Table: users    |
|   |   | └─ Table: orders   |
|   |   | └─ Function: calculate_total() |
|   |   └─ Schema: admin     |
|   |       | └─ Table: audit_log |
|   |       | └─ View: user_summary |
|   |   └─ Schema: billing    |
|   |       | └─ Table: invoices |
|   └─ Schema: billing        |
|       | └─ Table: invoices |
|       └─ Schema: billing    |
```



Fully qualified name: database.schema.object
OR (within current database): schema.object

Key facts:

- Objects in different schemas can have the same name without conflict
- Schemas are per-database — you cannot reference objects in other databases without `dblink` or foreign data wrappers
- Every database has a `public` schema by default
- Every database has `pg_catalog` and `information_schema` schemas (system)

The search_path

`search_path` is a list of schemas that PostgreSQL searches when you reference an unqualified object name.

```
-- View current search_path
SHOW search_path;
-- "$user", public    ← default

-- "$user" resolves to a schema with the same name as the current user
-- (if it exists; otherwise it is ignored)

-- Set search_path for current session
SET search_path = public, billing, admin;

-- Set search_path permanently for a user
ALTER USER app_user SET search_path = app, public;

-- Set search_path permanently for a database
ALTER DATABASE myapp SET search_path = app, public;

-- Set search_path for a function (recommended for security)
CREATE FUNCTION foo() RETURNS void
LANGUAGE SQL
SET search_path = myschema, pg_catalog -- pin the path
AS $$ SELECT 1 $$;
```

search_path resolution example

```
search_path = 'billing, public'
```

```
SELECT * FROM invoices;
```

1. Look for billing.invoices → found! Use it.

```
SELECT * FROM users;
  1. Look for billing.users      → not found
  2. Look for public.users       → found! Use it.

SELECT * FROM nonexistent;
  1. Look for billing.nonexistent → not found
  2. Look for public.nonexistent → not found
  → ERROR: relation "nonexistent" does not exist
```

Creating and Managing Schemas

```
-- Create schema
CREATE SCHEMA IF NOT EXISTS billing;

-- Create schema with owner
CREATE SCHEMA billing AUTHORIZATION billing_role;

-- Create schema and objects in one statement
CREATE SCHEMA app
  CREATE TABLE users (id SERIAL, email TEXT)
  CREATE VIEW active_users AS SELECT * FROM users;

-- Drop schema
DROP SCHEMA billing;           -- fails if schema is not empty
DROP SCHEMA billing CASCADE;  -- drops all contained objects
DROP SCHEMA billing RESTRICT;  -- same as DROP SCHEMA (default)

-- Rename schema
ALTER SCHEMA billing RENAME TO invoicing;

-- Change owner
ALTER SCHEMA billing OWNER TO billing_role;

-- List all schemas
SELECT schema_name, schema_owner
FROM information_schema.schemata
ORDER BY schema_name;

-- Or:
\dn      -- in psql
SELECT nspname, nspowner::regrole FROM pg_namespace;
```

Schema-Level Permissions

```
-- Schema privileges:
--  USAGE:  ability to reference objects in the schema (needed to use tables, etc.)
--  CREATE: ability to create objects in the schema
```

```

-- Grant usage (allows querying objects if table-level perms also granted)
GRANT USAGE ON SCHEMA billing TO app_user;

-- Grant create (allows creating new objects)
GRANT CREATE ON SCHEMA billing TO billing_admin;

-- Revoke
REVOKE CREATE ON SCHEMA billing FROM billing_admin;

-- Common pattern: read-only user
GRANT USAGE ON SCHEMA public TO readonly_user;
GRANT SELECT ON ALL TABLES IN SCHEMA public TO readonly_user;
-- Future tables:
ALTER DEFAULT PRIVILEGES IN SCHEMA public
    GRANT SELECT ON TABLES TO readonly_user;

-- Common pattern: app user (read/write, no DDL)
GRANT USAGE ON SCHEMA public TO app_user;
GRANT SELECT, INSERT, UPDATE, DELETE ON ALL TABLES IN SCHEMA public TO app_user;
GRANT USAGE ON ALL SEQUENCES IN SCHEMA public TO app_user;
ALTER DEFAULT PRIVILEGES IN SCHEMA public
    GRANT SELECT, INSERT, UPDATE, DELETE ON TABLES TO app_user;
ALTER DEFAULT PRIVILEGES IN SCHEMA public
    GRANT USAGE ON SEQUENCES TO app_user;

-- Public schema permissions (PostgreSQL 15+ changed defaults)
-- In PG 15+: public schema no longer world-writable by default
-- You must explicitly grant CREATE on public schema
GRANT CREATE ON SCHEMA public TO app_user;

```

Default Schemas in PostgreSQL

Schema	Purpose
public	Default schema for user objects
pg_catalog	System catalog tables (pg_class, pg_attribute, etc.)
information_schema	SQL standard views of catalog data
pg_toast	TOAST storage (not directly accessible)
pg_temp_N	Per-session temporary tables
pg_toast_temp_N	TOAST storage for temp tables

```

-- System catalog examples
SELECT relname, relkind
FROM pg_catalog.pg_class
WHERE relnamespace = 'public'::regnamespace
    AND relkind IN ('r', 'v', 'i') -- tables, views, indexes
ORDER BY relname;

-- information_schema: portable SQL standard views

```

```
SELECT table_name, table_type
FROM information_schema.tables
WHERE table_schema = 'public'
ORDER BY table_name;

SELECT column_name, data_type, is_nullable
FROM information_schema.columns
WHERE table_schema = 'public'
      AND table_name = 'users'
ORDER BY ordinal_position;
```

Cross-Schema Queries

```
-- Fully qualified names
SELECT * FROM billing.invoices;
SELECT * FROM public.users u JOIN billing.invoices i ON u.user_id = i.user_id;

-- Cross-schema view
CREATE VIEW public.invoice_with_customer AS
SELECT
    i.invoice_id,
    i.amount,
    u.email AS customer_email,
    u.full_name
FROM billing.invoices i
JOIN public.users u ON u.user_id = i.user_id;

-- Cross-database: NOT directly possible
-- Use foreign data wrapper (FDW) for cross-database access
CREATE EXTENSION IF NOT EXISTS postgres_fdw;

CREATE SERVER remote_db
    FOREIGN DATA WRAPPER postgres_fdw
    OPTIONS (host 'remote.server.com', dbname 'analytics');

CREATE USER MAPPING FOR app_user
    SERVER remote_db
    OPTIONS (user 'remote_user', password 'secret');

CREATE FOREIGN TABLE remote_events (
    event_id    BIGINT,
    event_type  TEXT,
    occurred_at TIMESTAMPTZ
) SERVER remote_db OPTIONS (schema_name 'public', table_name 'events');

SELECT * FROM remote_events WHERE occurred_at > now() - INTERVAL '1 day';
```

Schema Design Patterns

Pattern 1: Functional schemas (recommended for medium-large apps)

```
Database: myapp
├─ public      - shared/core tables (users, roles, etc.)
├─ billing     - invoices, payments, subscriptions
├─ catalog     - products, categories, inventory
├─ orders      - orders, order_items, shipping
├─ notifications - email_queue, push_queue, templates
├─ analytics   - aggregated tables, materialized views
└─ admin       - audit_log, config, admin-only views
```

Pattern 2: Versioned API schemas

```
Database: myapp
├─ api_v1      - views/functions exposing v1 API shape
├─ api_v2      - views/functions exposing v2 API shape
└─ internal    - actual tables (never exposed directly)
```

Pattern 3: ETL/Data Warehouse schemas

```
Database: warehouse
├─ raw         - raw ingested data (no transformations)
├─ staging     - cleaned/validated data
├─ core        - normalized/modelled facts and dimensions
├─ marts       - denormalized reporting tables
└─ reports     - final views for BI tools
```

Multi-Tenant Schema Patterns

Schema-per-tenant model

```
-- Create schema for each tenant
CREATE OR REPLACE FUNCTION create_tenant_schema(p_tenant_id TEXT)
RETURNS void LANGUAGE plpgsql AS $$
BEGIN
    EXECUTE format('CREATE SCHEMA IF NOT EXISTS tenant_%s', p_tenant_id);

    EXECUTE format($$
        CREATE TABLE tenant_%s.users (
            user_id      BIGINT GENERATED ALWAYS AS IDENTITY PRIMARY KEY,
            email        TEXT    NOT NULL UNIQUE,
            full_name    TEXT    NOT NULL,
            created_at   TIMESTAMPTZ NOT NULL DEFAULT now()
        )
    $$, p_tenant_id);

    EXECUTE format($$
        CREATE TABLE tenant_%s.orders (
            order_id     BIGINT GENERATED ALWAYS AS IDENTITY PRIMARY KEY,
```

```

        user_id      BIGINT NOT NULL REFERENCES tenant_%s.users(user_id),
        total        NUMERIC(12,4) NOT NULL,
        created_at   TIMESTAMPTZ NOT NULL DEFAULT now()
    )
    $$, p_tenant_id, p_tenant_id);

-- Grant to tenant-specific role
EXECUTE format('GRANT USAGE ON SCHEMA tenant_%s TO tenant_%s_role', p_tenant_id,
p_tenant_id);
EXECUTE format('GRANT ALL ON ALL TABLES IN SCHEMA tenant_%s TO tenant_%s_role',
p_tenant_id, p_tenant_id);
END;
$$;

-- Create tenant
SELECT create_tenant_schema('acme');
SELECT create_tenant_schema('globex');

-- Set tenant context at connection time
ALTER USER acme_app SET search_path = tenant_acme, public;

-- Application queries work without schema prefix
SET search_path = tenant_acme, public;
SELECT * FROM users; -- actually selects tenant_acme.users

```

Row-Level Security (shared schema, alternative to schema-per-tenant)

```

-- See ../14_Security/ for RLS-based multi-tenancy
-- schema-per-tenant vs RLS trade-offs covered in
06_Database_Design/07_schema_design_saas.md

```

Extensions and Schemas

```

-- Install extension in a specific schema
CREATE EXTENSION IF NOT EXISTS pg_trgm SCHEMA extensions;
CREATE EXTENSION IF NOT EXISTS "uuid-oss" SCHEMA extensions;

-- Add extensions schema to search_path
ALTER DATABASE myapp SET search_path = public, extensions;

-- View installed extensions
SELECT extname, extversion, nspname AS schema
FROM pg_extension
JOIN pg_namespace ON pg_namespace.oid = extnamespace;

-- Relocate an extension to a different schema (if supported)
ALTER EXTENSION pg_trgm SET SCHEMA public;

```

SQL Examples

Complete schema setup for a SaaS application

```
-- Create schemas
CREATE SCHEMA IF NOT EXISTS core;
CREATE SCHEMA IF NOT EXISTS billing;
CREATE SCHEMA IF NOT EXISTS analytics;

-- Roles
CREATE ROLE app_readonly;
CREATE ROLE app_readwrite;
CREATE ROLE billing_admin;

-- Core schema: shared user data
SET search_path = core;

CREATE TABLE users (
    user_id      BIGINT  GENERATED ALWAYS AS IDENTITY PRIMARY KEY,
    email        TEXT    NOT NULL UNIQUE,
    full_name    TEXT    NOT NULL,
    created_at   TIMESTAMPTZ NOT NULL DEFAULT now()
);

CREATE TABLE tenants (
    tenant_id    BIGINT  GENERATED ALWAYS AS IDENTITY PRIMARY KEY,
    name         TEXT    NOT NULL UNIQUE,
    slug         TEXT    NOT NULL UNIQUE CHECK (slug ~ '^[a-z0-9\-.]+$'),
    is_active    BOOLEAN NOT NULL DEFAULT TRUE,
    created_at   TIMESTAMPTZ NOT NULL DEFAULT now()
);

CREATE TABLE tenant_users (
    tenant_id    BIGINT NOT NULL REFERENCES tenants(tenant_id),
    user_id      BIGINT NOT NULL REFERENCES users(user_id),
    role         TEXT    NOT NULL DEFAULT 'member'
                    CHECK (role IN ('owner', 'admin', 'member')),
    joined_at    TIMESTAMPTZ NOT NULL DEFAULT now(),
    PRIMARY KEY (tenant_id, user_id)
);

-- Billing schema: financial data
SET search_path = billing;

CREATE TABLE subscriptions (
    sub_id       BIGINT  GENERATED ALWAYS AS IDENTITY PRIMARY KEY,
    tenant_id    BIGINT  NOT NULL REFERENCES core.tenants(tenant_id),
    plan         TEXT    NOT NULL CHECK (plan IN ('starter', 'pro', 'enterprise')),
    status       TEXT    NOT NULL DEFAULT 'active'
                    CHECK (status IN ('active', 'cancelled', 'past_due')),
    started_at   TIMESTAMPTZ NOT NULL DEFAULT now(),
```



```

        ends_at      TIMESTAMPTZ
    );

CREATE TABLE invoices (
    invoice_id BIGINT GENERATED ALWAYS AS IDENTITY PRIMARY KEY,
    tenant_id   BIGINT NOT NULL REFERENCES core.tenants(tenant_id),
    amount      NUMERIC(12,4) NOT NULL CHECK (amount > 0),
    status       TEXT NOT NULL DEFAULT 'unpaid'
                CHECK (status IN ('unpaid', 'paid', 'void')),
    issued_at    TIMESTAMPTZ NOT NULL DEFAULT now(),
    due_at       TIMESTAMPTZ NOT NULL DEFAULT now() + INTERVAL '30 days'
);

-- Analytics schema: reporting
SET search_path = analytics;

CREATE MATERIALIZED VIEW tenant_summary AS
SELECT
    t.tenant_id,
    t.name AS tenant_name,
    t.slug,
    count(DISTINCT tu.user_id) AS user_count,
    s.plan AS subscription_plan,
    s.status AS subscription_status,
    sum(i.amount) FILTER (WHERE i.status = 'paid') AS total_paid
FROM core.tenants t
LEFT JOIN core.tenant_users tu ON tu.tenant_id = t.tenant_id
LEFT JOIN billing.subscriptions s ON s.tenant_id = t.tenant_id AND s.status =
'active'
LEFT JOIN billing.invoices i ON i.tenant_id = t.tenant_id
GROUP BY t.tenant_id, t.name, t.slug, s.plan, s.status;

CREATE UNIQUE INDEX ON analytics.tenant_summary (tenant_id);

-- Grant permissions
GRANT USAGE ON SCHEMA core TO app_readonly, app_readwrite;
GRANT USAGE ON SCHEMA billing TO app_readwrite, billing_admin;
GRANT USAGE ON SCHEMA analytics TO app_readonly, app_readwrite;

GRANT SELECT ON ALL TABLES IN SCHEMA core TO app_readonly;
GRANT SELECT, INSERT, UPDATE, DELETE ON ALL TABLES IN SCHEMA core TO app_readwrite;

GRANT SELECT, INSERT, UPDATE, DELETE ON ALL TABLES IN SCHEMA billing TO
billing_admin;

-- Reset search_path
RESET search_path;

```

Common Mistakes

1. **Relying on `public` for everything** — As applications grow, everything in `public` becomes hard to manage. Use schemas for functional grouping from day one.

2. **Not setting `search_path` for functions (security risk)**

```
-- RISKY: if a malicious user creates a table/function named
'sensitive_function'
-- in their schema and it's earlier in search_path...
CREATE FUNCTION risky() RETURNS void AS $$ SELECT sensitive_function(); $$
LANGUAGE sql;

-- SAFE: pin the path
CREATE FUNCTION safe() RETURNS void
LANGUAGE sql SET search_path = myschema, pg_catalog
AS $$ SELECT myschema.sensitive_function(); $$;
```

3. **Forgetting to grant `USAGE` on schema in addition to table privileges**

```
-- This is insufficient:
GRANT SELECT ON billing.invoices TO app_user;
-- ERROR: permission denied for schema billing

-- Must also:
GRANT USAGE ON SCHEMA billing TO app_user;
GRANT SELECT ON billing.invoices TO app_user;
```

4. **Not using `ALTER DEFAULT PRIVILEGES` for future objects**

```
-- Granting on existing tables but not future ones:
GRANT SELECT ON ALL TABLES IN SCHEMA public TO readonly;
-- New tables created later won't be included!

-- Fix: add default privileges
ALTER DEFAULT PRIVILEGES IN SCHEMA public
    GRANT SELECT ON TABLES TO readonly;
```

5. **Using schema names with special characters or uppercasing**

```
CREATE SCHEMA "MySchema"; -- requires quotes everywhere!
SELECT * FROM "MySchema".users; -- annoying

-- Better: lowercase, no special chars
CREATE SCHEMA my_schema;
SELECT * FROM my_schema.users;
```

Best Practices

1. **Use schemas for functional grouping** of related tables/views/functions.

2. **Never put application objects in `pg_catalog`** — it's for system objects.
 3. **Set `search_path` explicitly** for application roles; don't rely on defaults.
 4. **Always pin `search_path` in functions** to prevent injection attacks.
 5. **Use `ALTER DEFAULT PRIVILEGES`** to ensure new objects inherit the right permissions.
 6. **Keep `public` schema minimal** — use it for truly shared objects or not at all.
 7. **For extensions**, create a dedicated `extensions` schema and add it to `search_path`.
 8. **Document schema purposes** in `COMMENT ON SCHEMA : COMMENT ON SCHEMA billing IS 'Financial data: invoices, payments, subscriptions' .`
-

Performance Considerations

- Schema separation has **zero performance impact** — schemas are purely a namespace/permission mechanism, not a storage boundary.
 - **Schema-per-tenant** approach means: more schemas → more objects in `pg_class` → slightly slower catalog queries (negligible at < 10,000 tenants).
 - For **very large multi-tenant systems** (> 10,000 tenants), prefer row-level security (shared schema) over schema-per-tenant to avoid catalog bloat.
 - `search_path` resolution adds a tiny overhead per query (catalog lookup) but is cached — negligible in practice.
 - **Function `search_path` pinning**: functions with a pinned `search_path` can be `IMMUTABLE` and may be inlined by the query planner.
-

Interview Questions & Answers

Q1: What is a schema in PostgreSQL and how is it different from a database?

A: A schema is a namespace within a database. A database is a completely separate collection of schemas, tables, and other objects — cross-database queries are not directly possible without FDW. Multiple schemas in one database can share data through joins. Databases are isolated. Use schemas for logical grouping within a database; use separate databases for completely isolated applications or environments.

Q2: What is `search_path` and why does it matter?

A: `search_path` is the ordered list of schemas PostgreSQL searches when resolving unqualified object names. If `search_path = 'billing, public'` and you write `SELECT * FROM invoices`, PostgreSQL looks for `billing.invoices` first, then `public.invoices`. It matters for security (schema injection attacks), portability (moving objects between schemas), and convenience (not having to qualify every name).

Q3: What is a `search_path` injection attack?

A: If a function doesn't pin its `search_path` and a malicious user creates an object with the same name in a schema that appears earlier in the search path, the function might call that malicious object instead of the intended one. The fix is to always set `search_path` in function definitions: `CREATE FUNCTION ... SET search_path = specific_schema, pg_catalog .`

Q4: How do schema permissions work — what is the difference between `USAGE` and `CREATE`?

A: `USAGE` on a schema allows users to reference objects within it (tables, functions, etc.) — they still need object-level permissions (`SELECT`, `INSERT`, etc.). `CREATE` allows users to create new objects (tables, functions, views) in the schema. Granting table `SELECT` without schema `USAGE` results in "permission denied for schema."

Q5: What is `ALTER DEFAULT PRIVILEGES` and when is it needed?

A: It sets permissions that are automatically applied to future objects created in a schema. Without it, every new table/function/view created by user A requires explicit grants to user B. With `ALTER DEFAULT PRIVILEGES IN SCHEMA public GRANT SELECT ON TABLES TO readonly`, all future tables automatically have SELECT granted to readonly.

Q6: How does schema-per-tenant differ from shared-schema multi-tenancy?

A: Schema-per-tenant: each tenant has their own schema with identical table structures. Strong isolation, easy per-tenant backup/restore, but catalog bloat at scale. Shared-schema: all tenants share the same tables with a `tenant_id` column; Row-Level Security controls access. Better performance at scale, simpler schema management, but weaker isolation boundary.

Q7: What happens to schema objects when you `DROP SCHEMA ... CASCADE` ?

A: All objects in the schema are dropped: tables (and their data!), views, functions, sequences, types, etc. This is irreversible. Always test schema drops in a non-production environment first and ensure you have a backup.

Q8: What is the difference between `pg_catalog` and `information_schema` ?

A: `pg_catalog` contains PostgreSQL-specific system tables (native format, most detailed, fastest). `information_schema` contains SQL-standard views that present catalog information in a portable format across databases. Use `information_schema` for portable scripts; use `pg_catalog` for PostgreSQL-specific tools and maximum performance.

Exercises with Solutions

Exercise 1

Create a multi-schema application with separate schemas for `app` (user-facing) and `audit` (logging). Set up appropriate permissions for a read-write app role and an audit reader role.

Solution:

```
CREATE SCHEMA app;
CREATE SCHEMA audit;

CREATE ROLE app_rw;
CREATE ROLE audit_reader;

-- App schema
CREATE TABLE app.users (
    user_id    BIGINT GENERATED ALWAYS AS IDENTITY PRIMARY KEY,
    email      TEXT NOT NULL UNIQUE,
    created_at TIMESTAMPTZ NOT NULL DEFAULT now()
);

-- Audit schema
CREATE TABLE audit.user_changes (
    change_id  BIGINT GENERATED ALWAYS AS IDENTITY PRIMARY KEY,
    table_name TEXT NOT NULL,
    operation  TEXT NOT NULL,
```

```

    old_data    JSONB,
    new_data    JSONB,
    changed_by  TEXT NOT NULL DEFAULT current_user,
    changed_at  TIMESTAMPTZ NOT NULL DEFAULT now()
);

-- Permissions
GRANT USAGE ON SCHEMA app TO app_rw;
GRANT SELECT, INSERT, UPDATE, DELETE ON ALL TABLES IN SCHEMA app TO app_rw;
GRANT USAGE ON ALL SEQUENCES IN SCHEMA app TO app_rw;

GRANT USAGE ON SCHEMA audit TO app_rw;
GRANT INSERT ON audit.user_changes TO app_rw;

GRANT USAGE ON SCHEMA audit TO audit_reader;
GRANT SELECT ON ALL TABLES IN SCHEMA audit TO audit_reader;

-- Future objects
ALTER DEFAULT PRIVILEGES IN SCHEMA app
    GRANT SELECT, INSERT, UPDATE, DELETE ON TABLES TO app_rw;
ALTER DEFAULT PRIVILEGES IN SCHEMA audit
    GRANT SELECT ON TABLES TO audit_reader;

```

Exercise 2

Write a stored procedure that dynamically creates a new tenant schema with a standardized set of tables.

Solution:

```

CREATE OR REPLACE PROCEDURE provision_tenant(p_tenant_slug TEXT)
LANGUAGE plpgsql AS $$
DECLARE
    v_schema TEXT := format('tenant_%s', p_tenant_slug);
BEGIN
    -- Validate slug
    IF p_tenant_slug !~ '^ [a-z][a-z0-9_]{1,62}$' THEN
        RAISE EXCEPTION 'Invalid tenant slug: %', p_tenant_slug;
    END IF;

    -- Create schema
    EXECUTE format('CREATE SCHEMA IF NOT EXISTS %I', v_schema);

    -- Standard tables
    EXECUTE format($$
        CREATE TABLE %I.settings (
            key    TEXT PRIMARY KEY,
            value  JSONB NOT NULL,
            updated_at TIMESTAMPTZ NOT NULL DEFAULT now()
        )
    $$, v_schema);

    EXECUTE format($$

```

```
CREATE TABLE %I.users (  
    user_id    BIGINT GENERATED ALWAYS AS IDENTITY PRIMARY KEY,  
    email      TEXT NOT NULL UNIQUE,  
    role       TEXT NOT NULL DEFAULT 'member',  
    created_at TIMESTAMPTZ NOT NULL DEFAULT now()  
)  
$$, v_schema);  
  
RAISE NOTICE 'Tenant schema % created successfully', v_schema;  
END;  
$$;  
  
CALL provision_tenant('acme_corp');  
CALL provision_tenant('beta_startup');
```

Cross-References

- [08_constraints.md](#) — constraint naming across schemas
- [../14_Security/](#) — schema permissions and Row-Level Security
- [../06_Database_Design/07_schema_design_saas.md](#) — multi-tenant patterns in depth
- [../12_Production_PostgreSQL/](#) — schema maintenance and monitoring